01_HR_Employee_Handbook

Meridian Global Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Document classification: Internal — HR Access Only **Applies to:** All full-time and contract employees **Last reviewed:** January 2026 | **Owner:** People & Culture Team

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1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook sets out the terms of employment, workplace conduct expectations, and HR policies applicable to all employees of Meridian Global Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (“the Company”). It is intended to be read alongside an employee’s individual offer letter and employment agreement. In case of conflict, the individual agreement takes precedence for matters specific to that employee.

All employees are required to read and acknowledge this handbook within their first two weeks of joining, via the HR portal.

2. Employment Classification

The Company recognizes the following employment categories:

Category	Description	Benefits Eligibility
Full-time permanent	Regular, indefinite employment	Full benefits
Fixed-term contract	Employment for a defined period (6-24 months)	Pro-rated benefits

Intern	Structured training placement, 3-6 months	Stipend only, no benefits
Consultant	Engaged via separate service agreement	Not applicable

Probation period for full-time permanent employees is 90 days from the date of joining, extendable once by 30 days at the discretion of the reporting manager and HR.

3. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act with integrity, professionalism, and respect toward colleagues, clients, and partners at all times. Specific expectations include:

- Punctuality and reliable attendance in accordance with the Leave and Attendance Policy.
- Maintaining confidentiality of proprietary, client, and employee information.
- Avoiding conflicts of interest, including outside employment that competes with Company business.
- Treating all colleagues with respect regardless of gender, religion, ethnicity, disability, or sexual orientation.
- Reporting any suspected violation of Company policy through the channels described in Section 8.

Violations of the Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, as outlined in Section 7.

4. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours (when all employees are expected to be reachable) are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM.

Employees working in hybrid or remote arrangements must log attendance via the HR portal by 10:00 AM each working day. Repeated unexplained absence from core hours may trigger a review by the reporting manager.

Flexible start times (between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM) are permitted with prior manager approval, provided the 9-hour workday (including lunch) is maintained.

5. Compensation and Benefits Overview

Salary is disbursed on the last working day of each month via direct bank transfer. Payslips are available on the HR portal by the 2nd working day of the following month.

Standard benefits for full-time permanent employees include:

- Group health insurance covering the employee, spouse, and up to two dependent children.
- Group term life insurance equal to 3x annual base salary.
- Employee Provident Fund (EPF) contribution as per statutory requirements.
- Annual health check-up reimbursement up to INR 5,000.
- Wellness allowance of INR 2,000 per quarter (gym, mental health apps, etc.).

Detailed compensation structure, including variable pay and stock options where applicable, is communicated individually and is not covered in this general handbook.

6. Performance Management

Performance is reviewed on a bi-annual cycle (April-September and October-March). Each cycle includes:

1. Goal-setting at the start of the cycle, aligned to team and company objectives.
2. A mid-cycle check-in between employee and manager.
3. A formal written review at the end of the cycle, with a rating on a 5-point scale.
4. Calibration across teams to ensure consistency of ratings.

Ratings feed into annual compensation review and promotion consideration. Employees rated below expectations for two consecutive cycles are placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP), managed jointly by the manager and HR Business Partner.

7. Disciplinary Procedure

The Company follows a progressive disciplinary approach for policy violations, except in cases of gross misconduct (e.g. harassment, fraud, safety violations), which may result in immediate termination:

Step	Action	Documentation
1st occurrence	Verbal warning	Noted in HR file
2nd occurrence	Written warning	Signed acknowledgment required
3rd occurrence	Final written warning	HR Business Partner involved
4th occurrence	Termination review	Formal hearing, HR + Legal

Employees have the right to respond to any disciplinary action in writing before a final decision is made.

8. Grievance Redressal

Employees who experience or witness a policy violation, unfair treatment, or workplace conflict may raise a grievance through any of the following channels:

- Direct conversation with their reporting manager.
- Email to hr-grievance@meridianglobal.example (monitored by HR Business Partners only).
- Anonymous submission via the HR portal’s Ethics Line.

All grievances are acknowledged within 3 working days and investigated within 15 working days. Retaliation against an employee for raising a grievance in good faith is itself a violation of Company policy and will be treated as gross misconduct.

9. Anti-Harassment Policy

The Company maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment of any kind, including sexual harassment, bullying, and discrimination. This policy applies to interactions with colleagues, clients, vendors, and third parties, both in person and via digital communication channels.

All complaints are handled by the Internal Committee (IC) constituted under applicable law, with strict confidentiality maintained throughout the investigation process.

10. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Employees must not disclose confidential Company information, client data, or personal data of colleagues to any unauthorized party, during or after employment. This includes:

- Client contracts, pricing, and deliverables.

- Unreleased product plans and technical designs.
- Employee compensation, performance ratings, and personal records.
- Any information accessed through internal systems that falls outside the employee’s role scope.

Violation of confidentiality obligations may result in disciplinary action and, where applicable, legal proceedings.

11. Exit Process Overview

Employees resigning from the Company are required to serve the notice period specified in their employment agreement (typically 30-90 days). The exit process includes:

1. Formal resignation submission via the HR portal.
2. Knowledge transfer plan agreed with the reporting manager.
3. Return of Company assets (laptop, access card, other equipment).
4. Exit interview with HR.
5. Full and final settlement processed within 45 days of the last working day.

12. Contact and Escalation

For questions regarding this handbook, employees may contact their assigned HR Business Partner or write to hr-support@meridianglobal.example. Urgent matters involving safety or harassment should be escalated immediately using the channels in Section 8, regardless of time of day.